

THE LANDLORD'S GUIDE TO

SHROA 2023 ***Compliance***

What private landlords need to know before the mid-2027 licensing regime goes live

Education before obligation.

This guide explains the Supported Housing (Regulatory Oversight) Act 2023 in plain language — the timeline, what licensing will require, and the five questions every landlord should ask before signing a lease with a supported housing operator.

No email capture. No strings. Just the information you need.

Mid-2027

When the licensing regime goes live across England

31 Mar 2027

Deadline for local authorities to publish
Local Supported Housing Strategies

5

Questions to ask any operator before you sign a lease



Every landlord considering a supported housing lease should understand this framework before signing anything.

The Act was created in response to rogue operators, fraudulent rent collection, and safeguarding failures. It introduces national standards and local licensing determining who can legally operate from mid-2027.

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What Is **SHROA 2023** — and Why Should You Care?

PLAIN LANGUAGE SUMMARY

The Supported Housing (Regulatory Oversight) Act 2023 creates a licensing regime for supported housing operators across England. Royal Assent: 29 June 2023. Licensing goes live mid-2027. Any operator without a licence cannot place new tenants or receive Housing Benefit. Your rental income depends on your operator achieving and holding that licence.

CRITICAL TIMELINE

- | | |
|----------------|--|
| Now — Mar 2027 | ● Local authorities developing Local Supported Housing Strategies. Commissioning relationships formed now determine who gets licensed. |
| Late 2026 | ● Government publishes draft licensing regulations. Operators must assess compliance gap and begin licence preparation. |
| 31 March 2027 | ● Local authority strategies published. Commissioning priorities confirmed. Council relationships crystallise. |
| Mid-2027 | ● Licensing regimes go live. Unlicensed operators cannot place tenants or receive Housing Benefit. Enforcement begins. |

WHY SHROA 2023 WAS CREATED

London Assembly — March 2023

£107m spent by 16 London boroughs on exempt accommodation. At least 2 deaths documented. Operators found targeting vulnerable people. Cross-party calls for national regulation followed.

Home REIT — January 2023-2026

£850m raised, 94% lost. SFO arrested 6 people in January 2026 for suspected £300m fraud. Property valuations inflated; rent collection falsified throughout.

What Councils Are Doing *Right Now* — and What Licensing Means for You

The decisions councils are making today will determine which operators thrive from mid-2027 onwards.

Operators already in council conversations are building the relationships that will matter at licensing. Your income after 2027 depends on your operator being in the right room today.

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THE STRATEGY DEADLINE — 31 MARCH 2027

Every local authority in England must publish a Local Supported Housing Strategy by 31 March 2027. Councils are right now mapping current supply, projecting demand across homelessness, care leavers, domestic abuse survivors and rough sleepers, identifying gaps, and deciding which operators they want to work with. This is happening in every council chamber across England today.

HOW LICENSING WILL WORK FROM MID-2027

National Standards Will Cover

- Property standards — EPC rating, fire safety, condition, accessibility
- Support standards — staffing, safeguarding, tenant involvement
- Financial standards — rent collection, reserves, controls

Without a Licence, an Operator Cannot

- Place any new tenants in supported housing
- Receive Housing Benefit payments from the local authority
- Continue operating without enforcement action

THE DIRECT IMPLICATION FOR YOU AS A LANDLORD

Your lease is only as valuable as your operator's licence. If your operator cannot secure a licence by mid-2027, Housing Benefit payments stop, your rental income stops, and your property may be caught in a forced handover. The question to ask today — not in 2027 — is whether the operator you are considering is actively building toward compliance right now.

THREE QUESTIONS TO ASK ABOUT COUNCIL ENGAGEMENT

- Are you contributing data to our local authority's strategy development process?
- Do you have a named relationship with the commissioning team in any local authority?
- Can you demonstrate active, documented conversation with at least one council?

Five Questions to Ask Any Operator *Before You Sign*

*You own the property.
You have every right to
demand clear, written
answers to each of these
before committing to any
multi-year agreement.*

An operator who cannot answer these questions clearly and in writing is an operator whose licence — and your income — is at risk when 2027 arrives.

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1 *"Can you show me your published operational standards — property spec, EPC targets, tenant selection criteria?"*

Operators building toward licensing prepare and publish standards now. Nothing published means nothing prepared — and no licence in 2027.

2 *"Can you share your quarterly rent collection rates — actual figures, not projections?"*

Home REIT collapsed because rent collection was hidden. Transparent operators publish this data quarterly. Opacity here is a serious warning sign.

3 *"Which Registered Provider manages the properties? Can you give me their government registration details to verify?"*

The RP is verifiable on the Regulator of Social Housing register. If the operator won't name them, or the RP is not registered, do not proceed.

4 *"What is your specific plan for mid-2027 licensing — which national standards are you already meeting today?"*

Vague answers reveal operators who are not preparing. Your income in 2027 depends on their readiness today.

5 *"Can I review a specimen lease with my solicitor before signing anything?"*

Standard, publishable lease terms signal nothing to hide. Refusal signals opacity. Always have a solicitor review any multi-year agreement.

Red Flags & Green Flags — Your Final Evaluation Checklist

Do not sign a multi-year agreement based on promises. Sign based on evidence — published standards, verifiable data, a named RP, a readable lease.

Government resources:

SHROA 2023:
legislation.gov.uk

RSH register:
[gov.uk/guidance/
register-of-providers](https://gov.uk/guidance/register-of-providers)

MHCLG guidance:
gov.uk — search
"Local Supported
Housing Strategies"

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RED FLAGS — WALK AWAY

- ✗ No published operational standards
- ✗ Refuses to share rent collection data
- ✗ Won't name the Registered Provider
- ✗ No specific licensing preparation plan
- ✗ Won't provide a specimen lease
- ✗ No named team or verifiable track record
- ✗ "Guaranteed rent" language in the pitch
- ✗ No evidence of council engagement

GREEN FLAGS — PROCEED WITH DILIGENCE

- ✓ Operational standards published online
- ✓ Quarterly rent collection data available
- ✓ RP named and verifiable on RSH register
- ✓ Specific, dated licensing roadmap exists
- ✓ Specimen lease available for solicitor review
- ✓ Named team with public profiles and track record
- ✓ Documented, active local authority engagement
- ✓ Proactive about discussing risks, not just benefits

FINAL WORD

You own the property. You decide who leases it. If an operator cannot answer the five questions on the previous page clearly and in writing, that tells you everything you need to know. This guide is educational only and does not constitute legal advice. Consult a solicitor before signing any lease agreement.